

Epic Systems Corporation

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill — Office of Innovation and Commercialization

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Company Overview

Epic Systems Corporation is a large private healthcare software company headquartered in Verona, Wisconsin. Founded in 1979, Epic develops and maintains electronic health record systems, patient engagement platforms, clinical analytics tools, and a growing portfolio of AI capabilities for health systems, hospitals, and clinics.

Epic is relevant for partnership discussions for a reason no other company in this profile set shares: UNC Health is an active, long-term Epic customer with a documented history of co-developing and early-adopting Epic AI features. Beyond the UNC Health operational relationship, Epic is relevant because its Cosmos research database — covering more than 300 million deidentified patient records from 1,760-plus participating hospitals — represents one of the largest structured clinical research datasets in existence, with a documented publication program and an AI development initiative that creates direct alignment with UNC capabilities in biomedical informatics, clinical research infrastructure, health data science, implementation science, and applied machine learning.

Sources: Epic Systems corporate site [1]; Becker's Hospital Review [2]; Epic Cosmos [3].

Basic Company Information

Full Name	Epic Systems Corporation
Headquarters	Verona, Wisconsin, United States
Website	https://www.epic.com
Developer Platform	https://open.epic.com
FHIR Resources	https://fhir.epic.com
Cosmos Research	https://cosmos.epic.com
Company Type	Private Company (no SEC filings)
Ticker	N/A (privately held)
Industry	Healthcare Software / Electronic Health Records / Clinical AI

Scale	Large Enterprise (privately held)
Founded	1979
CEO	Judith Faulkner

Sources: Epic Systems corporate site [1]; Becker's Hospital Review [2].

Business Signals: Revenue and Market Position 2024–2026

Revenue

Revenue: \$5.7B in 2024 (confirmed by company spokesperson to Becker's Hospital Review), up from \$4.9B in 2023 and \$1.2B in 2012. Epic is privately held and does not publish quarterly earnings, investor relations filings, or audited annual financial statements. All revenue figures should be attributed to company-confirmed disclosures reported by Becker's Hospital Review.

Market Position

- 43.7% of U.S. acute care EHR market as of year-end 2025, up from 42.3% at year-end 2024 (KLAS Research, published May 2026).
- 54.9% of U.S. acute care hospital beds by market share in 2024; Oracle Health 22.1%; Meditech 12.7%.
- Active in 3,620 U.S. hospitals and health systems as of August 2025.
- Net gain of 176 acute care multispecialty hospitals in 2024 — largest single-year net gain on record. Oracle Health lost a net 74 hospital sites in the same period.
- Won nearly 70% of new hospital contracts executed in 2024.
- Gained 77 multispecialty hospitals in 2025 despite a 40% industry-wide decline in EHR purchase decisions.
- New customers announced at UGM 2025 include UAB Medicine, Indiana University Health, Baptist Health South Florida, and MedStar Health.

Sources: Becker's Hospital Review [2]; Fierce Healthcare [5]; Dark Daily [6]; Sacra [7].

Platform Structure

Epic operates as a vertically integrated clinical platform. Its core EHR, patient engagement, analytics, interoperability, and research systems are built on a proprietary data architecture (Chronicles) and accessed through a common client interface (Hyperspace). All external integration is conducted through APIs.

Core Platform Layers

- **Epic EHR (Hyperspace):** Clinical documentation, ordering, and workflow system deployed at 3,620 U.S. hospitals and health systems as of August 2025.

- **MyChart:** Patient-facing portal and mobile application with more than 180 million active U.S. users. MyChart Central — a single Epic-issued patient ID connecting records across provider organizations — was rolling out as of September 2025.
- **Cosmos:** Deidentified opt-in research database covering more than 300 million patients globally, 16 billion+ clinical encounters across four countries, from 1,760+ participating hospitals. Epic's primary platform for population-level research, comparative effectiveness, and foundation model development.
- **Caboodle and Clarity:** Enterprise data warehouse and reporting database layers supporting population health analytics, quality reporting, and research. Clarity data model made available for developer licensing in 2025.
- **Care Everywhere:** Health information exchange network for clinical data sharing between Epic organizations and external health systems.
- **Community Connect:** Hosted extension model enabling smaller hospitals and ambulatory practices to run on a host Epic instance. Captured nearly 70% of standalone hospital EHR decisions in 2024.
- **Health Grid:** Connectivity layer for exchanging data with payers, specialty diagnostic labs, medical devices, and telehealth companies.

Developer and Interoperability Platform

- **open.epic:** Public developer platform providing free resources, technical documentation, API specifications, and sandbox access.
- **Epic on FHIR (fhir.epic.com):** 450-plus FHIR APIs across 55 resources. Argonaut Project and Da Vinci Project membership. International Patient Summary FHIR support added May 2025.
- **Showroom (formerly App Orchard):** Curated app marketplace for third-party developers that have passed Epic's technical, security, and HIPAA compliance review.

Sources: open.epic [8]; Epic FHIR documentation [9]; Fierce Healthcare [10]; Epic Cosmos [3]; Epic UGM 2025 coverage [11].

Strategic Themes

- Dominant and expanding EHR market position: 43.7% of U.S. acute care hospitals and approximately 55% of U.S. acute care hospital beds as of year-end 2025.
- Revenue growth from \$4.9B in 2023 to \$5.7B in 2024 confirming sustained demand.
- Cosmos as a research and AI asset: 300 million deidentified patient records from 1,760+ hospitals, active academic publication program, new AI model development initiative announced at UGM 2025.
- Broad AI development across 160–200 features spanning clinical documentation, revenue cycle, patient engagement, diagnostic support, and disease monitoring.
- 450-plus FHIR APIs, SMART on FHIR, Care Everywhere, Argonaut and Da Vinci Project membership, and International Patient Summary support.
- Active partnership with Microsoft and Nuance for ambient clinical documentation AI embedded in Epic, with UNC Health among early deployment sites.

- **ERP expansion:** Epic is developing an enterprise resource planning suite to extend its footprint from clinical into operational and financial systems.

Sources: Becker's Hospital Review [2]; KLAS Research via Fierce Healthcare [5]; Epic Cosmos [3]; CNBC [13]; Fierce Healthcare [14].

AI and Technology Signals

Epic's AI posture as of August 2025 is defined by scale of proprietary data assets, broad integration across existing workflows, and a deliberate shift from third-party model reliance toward internally trained foundation models. At UGM 2025, CEO Judith Faulkner stated: "We've got somewhere between 160 and 200 AI projects going. Some of them are completed and some are in process."

Cosmos AI and CoMET

Epic announced proprietary foundation models called Cosmos AI at UGM 2025, trained on the Cosmos deidentified patient dataset, and launched the Cosmos AI Lab to allow researchers and data scientists to explore the models.

CoMET (Generative Medical Event Models): A model that — analogously to how large language models predict the next token — predicts the next medical event in a patient's trajectory, such as readmission risk, future diagnoses, or clinical deterioration. Executives stated the models improve in predictive accuracy as the Cosmos dataset grows. Epic is evaluating use cases including proactive risk identification and real-world evidence generation for clinical decision support.

Named AI Features and Agents (UGM 2025)

- **Art for Clinicians:** An ambient AI clinical assistant supporting documentation and clinical workflow.
- **Emmie:** An AI-powered patient-facing chatbot for engagement, scheduling, and care navigation.
- **Penny:** An AI revenue management assistant for revenue cycle automation.
- **Ambient AI Charting:** Integrated with Microsoft Nuance Dragon Ambient eXperience (DAX) for ambient clinical documentation. UNC Health is among the health systems deploying this capability at scale.
- **Diagnostic Adviser:** A Cosmos-driven point-of-care tool that alerts clinicians when an alternative diagnosis may better fit a patient's data pattern. Epic cited that 10–20% of diagnoses may be incorrect, motivating the tool.
- **Disease Outbreak Prediction:** A Cosmos-based population health tool using AI to predict and monitor disease outbreaks.
- **AI Charting / Generative AI Patient Message Response:** Generative AI for auto-drafting clinician responses to patient messages. UNC Health was one of the first health systems to adopt the feature in 2023.

Caution: Epic's CoMET and Cosmos AI models are in active development and have not been published in peer-reviewed literature as of the date of this profile. Keep AI claims tied to UGM 2025 announcements and avoid characterizing model performance as clinically validated unless separately sourced.

Sources: CNBC [13]; Fierce Healthcare [11]; Healthcare IT News [7]; STAT News [15]; Fierce Healthcare [14].

Cosmos Research Database and Academic Collaboration

Cosmos is the most significant research-relevant asset in Epic's portfolio for academic partnership purposes. The database is structured as an opt-in collaborative: health systems must agree to contribute all their data to the Cosmos community and to not sell access to it. Epic coordinates the research program and publishes studies through an internal team, while also supporting external academic publication.

Cosmos participants with documented publications include Yale New Haven Health System and Yale University, Ohio State University Wexner Medical Center, Children's Hospital of Philadelphia, RUSH University System for Health, Loma Linda University Medical Center, University of Texas Southwestern Medical Center, and the University of Arkansas for Medical Sciences, among others.

Cosmos Genomics Expansion: Cosmos is expanding to include genomic variant data, combining genetic and EHR-derived digital phenotypes in a single dataset — a development with direct implications for precision medicine research programs.

The Cosmos AI Lab, announced at UGM 2025, provides a structured mechanism for researchers and data scientists to engage with Epic's Cosmos-trained foundation models, with the explicit goal of supporting external research collaboration alongside Epic's internal development program.

Note on Cosmos participation: UNC Health's status as an active Epic customer makes it eligible to participate in Cosmos if it has opted in. A follow-up research pass targeting UNC Health's Cosmos participation status is recommended before characterizing UNC as a Cosmos data contributor in any formal outreach.

Sources: Epic Cosmos [3]; Cosmos publications [18]; Medscape [17]; Healthcare IT Today [19].

UNC Health — Documented Operational and AI Relationship

UNC Health has a documented, multi-year, and actively expanding relationship with Epic that is unique among the companies profiled in this series. The relationship is operational (Epic is UNC Health's EHR), research-enabling (UNC Health is Cosmos-eligible), and specifically AI-focused through documented co-adoption of Epic and Microsoft AI features.

Documented Milestones

- **EHR Implementation (~2014):** UNC Health Care completed implementation of Epic as its enterprise EHR system. Epic@UNC has served as the clinical backbone of UNC Health's 20 hospitals and more than 900 clinics.

- **Generative AI Patient Messaging (2023):** UNC Health was selected by Epic as one of the first health systems to test generative AI tools for auto-drafting clinician responses to patient messages. Initial rollout began with five to ten physicians at UNC Health. Leadership publicly cited the partnership as an effort to reduce clinician administrative burden.
- **Nuance DAX Copilot Expansion (2024):** UNC Health expanded the deployment of Nuance Dragon Ambient eXperience Copilot (DAX Copilot) — Microsoft's ambient clinical documentation AI embedded in Epic — to more providers across the health system. UNC Health was among 150 health systems deploying the tool at scale.
- **Rare Disease Coding Tool Launch (February 2026):** UNC Health launched what it described as the world's first standardized rare-disease coding tool, integrating Mondo Disease Ontology codes into its Epic EHR as part of Epic's February 2026 software update. The tool introduces nearly 5,000 new rare disease codes and revises more than 25,000 related disease codes within Epic, available across UNC Health's 20 hospitals and 900-plus clinics.

These documented milestones establish UNC Health — and, by extension, UNC — as an active, publicly visible co-development and early-adoption partner for Epic's most strategically significant AI and clinical informatics initiatives.

Sources: Becker's [20]; Fierce Healthcare [16]; Fierce Healthcare [14]; Becker's [21].

Alignment with UNC Research

A direct UNC–Epic institutional research partnership has not been identified from the current source set beyond the UNC Health operational relationship documented above. The following represents additional strategic alignment based on documented Epic capabilities and UNC academic research strengths.

Strategic Fit Areas

- **Biomedical informatics and EHR-derived data science:** UNC's CHIP program and biomedical informatics groups work directly with clinical data types that Epic's Cosmos, Clarity, and Caboodle platforms are designed to support.
- **Clinical AI evaluation and implementation science:** Epic's AI features require clinical validation in real care environments. UNC health system researchers and implementation scientists are well positioned to study adoption, workflow integration, and outcomes for these tools.
- **Rare disease and precision medicine research:** UNC Health's February 2026 launch of the Mondo Disease Ontology coding tool in Epic positions UNC as a leader in rare disease classification within the Epic ecosystem.
- **Population health analytics and public health:** Cosmos's disease outbreak prediction initiative and population-level data assets align with UNC Gillings School of Global Public Health analytics and epidemiology groups.
- **Informatics education and clinical training pipelines:** UNC's CHIP program benefits from close engagement with the dominant EHR platform — creating natural alignment for curriculum, practicum, and research partnerships.

- **FHIR and interoperability research:** UNC biomedical informatics and computer science groups working on health data interoperability, SMART on FHIR app development, or clinical data exchange are well positioned to engage with Epic's open developer ecosystem.

Recommended Enrichment Targets

- UNC Health IT leadership and Epic@UNC team — to confirm Cosmos participation and identify existing Epic research collaboration structures
 - UNC Biomedical Informatics program (CHIP)
 - UNC School of Medicine — clinical informatics, rare disease, and precision medicine programs
 - UNC Gillings School of Global Public Health — population health analytics and epidemiology groups
 - UNC Department of Computer Science — health data interoperability and NLP faculty
 - UNC health behavior and implementation science groups
 - UNC Eshelman School of Pharmacy — clinical trial management and drug information research
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Talking Points

Organizational Context

- Epic is the dominant U.S. EHR vendor by both hospital count and bed share: 43.7% of acute care hospitals and approximately 55% of acute care hospital beds as of year-end 2025 per KLAS Research. Its nearest competitor, Oracle Health, holds 22.9%.
- Revenue reached \$5.7B in 2024, confirmed by a company spokesperson. As a private company, Epic does not publish SEC filings; revenue figures should be attributed to company-confirmed reporting.
- Epic should be framed as a clinical infrastructure company, not a general-purpose technology or consumer platform company. Its value to UNC is grounded in the fact that UNC Health runs on Epic, UNC Health has already served as an early-adoption site for Epic AI, and Epic's Cosmos database is one of the most significant clinical data assets available to participating health systems.
- Epic's AI roadmap is substantial — 160 to 200 features in development or deployed — and is increasingly built on proprietary foundation models trained on Cosmos data rather than exclusively on third-party model partnerships.

Alignment with UNC Research

- UNC's positioning with Epic is not hypothetical. UNC Health was publicly selected by Epic to pilot generative AI patient message tools in 2023, expanded Nuance DAX Copilot embedded in Epic in 2024, and launched a world-first rare disease coding tool in Epic in February 2026. These are documented, public milestones.
- The strongest outreach angle for the Office of Innovation and Commercialization is not a cold partnership pitch — it is extending an already-active operational and AI co-development relationship into a structured research collaboration, potentially including Cosmos data access agreements, funded studies, or joint development of AI validation frameworks.

- For UNC researchers outside the health system, the most accessible entry points are Epic's open developer ecosystem (open.epic, fhir.epic.com) and the documented Cosmos academic publication program, which already includes peer-reviewed publications from Yale, Ohio State, and Children's Hospital of Philadelphia.
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Risk and Caution Notes

- Do not overstate the UNC–Epic relationship as a formal research partnership. The documented relationship is between UNC Health (the clinical enterprise) and Epic. Confirm whether existing agreements cover academic research collaboration, IP licensing, or Cosmos data access before making partnership claims.
 - Do not attribute Epic financial figures to audited disclosures; they come from company-confirmed reporting to Becker's Hospital Review. Epic does not publish SEC filings.
 - Do not present CoMET or Cosmos AI models as clinically validated. As of August 2025, these are development-stage models with no peer-reviewed performance data identified in the current source set.
 - Epic is subject to active antitrust litigation as of late 2025: a federal judge allowed Particle Health's Sherman Act Section 2 claims to proceed in September 2025, and the Texas Attorney General filed suit in December 2025 alleging monopolization. Do not characterize Epic's market position in ways that could be construed as endorsing challenged practices.
 - Keep Cosmos participation claims about UNC Health conditional — confirm UNC Health's opt-in status through a direct follow-up before asserting it in partnership materials.
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Expected Report Angle and Positioning

Positioning Summary: Epic should be framed as (1) the dominant U.S. EHR platform with 43.7% of acute care hospitals and \$5.7B in 2024 revenue, making it the primary clinical infrastructure partner for any academic medical center conducting EHR-linked research; (2) the operator of Cosmos, one of the largest deidentified clinical research databases in existence, with 300 million patient records and an active AI model development program; (3) an already-active operational and AI co-development partner for UNC Health specifically, with three publicly documented milestones between 2023 and 2026; (4) a different category of partner than Apple, Google, or Microsoft — not a cloud or consumer platform company, but the clinical data infrastructure layer inside which UNC Health already operates every day; and (5) a company whose strategic trajectory toward proprietary foundation models trained on clinical data, clinical AI agents, and ERP expansion makes the academic medical center relationship more, not less, valuable over time.

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